



ABDUL KHALIQ

AUTOMATE YOUR APPROVALS WORKFLOW WITH SHAREPOINT & POWER AUTOMATE





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WHAT DO YOU NEED?

STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS
ACCOUNTS PAYABLE
INVOICES AS AN
EXAMPLE



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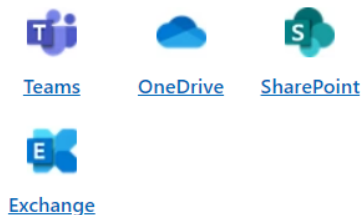
STEP 1: MICROSOFT 365 SUBSCRIPTION

1

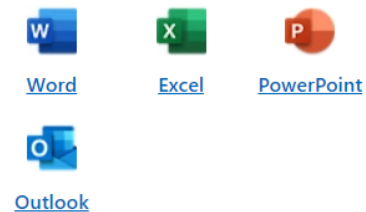
Obtain a Microsoft 365 Business Subscription

- Visit the Microsoft 365 Business Subscription page.
- Choose the appropriate plan and follow the instructions to subscribe.

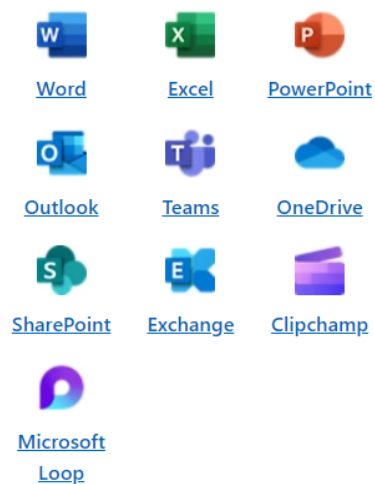
Secure cloud services:



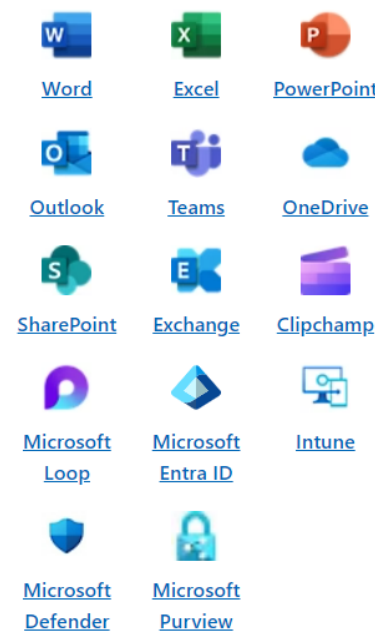
Web and mobile apps only:



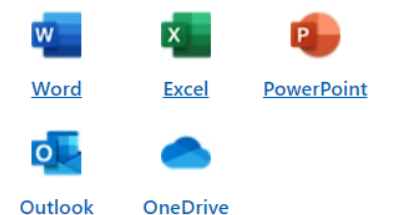
Desktop, web, and mobile apps and secure cloud services:



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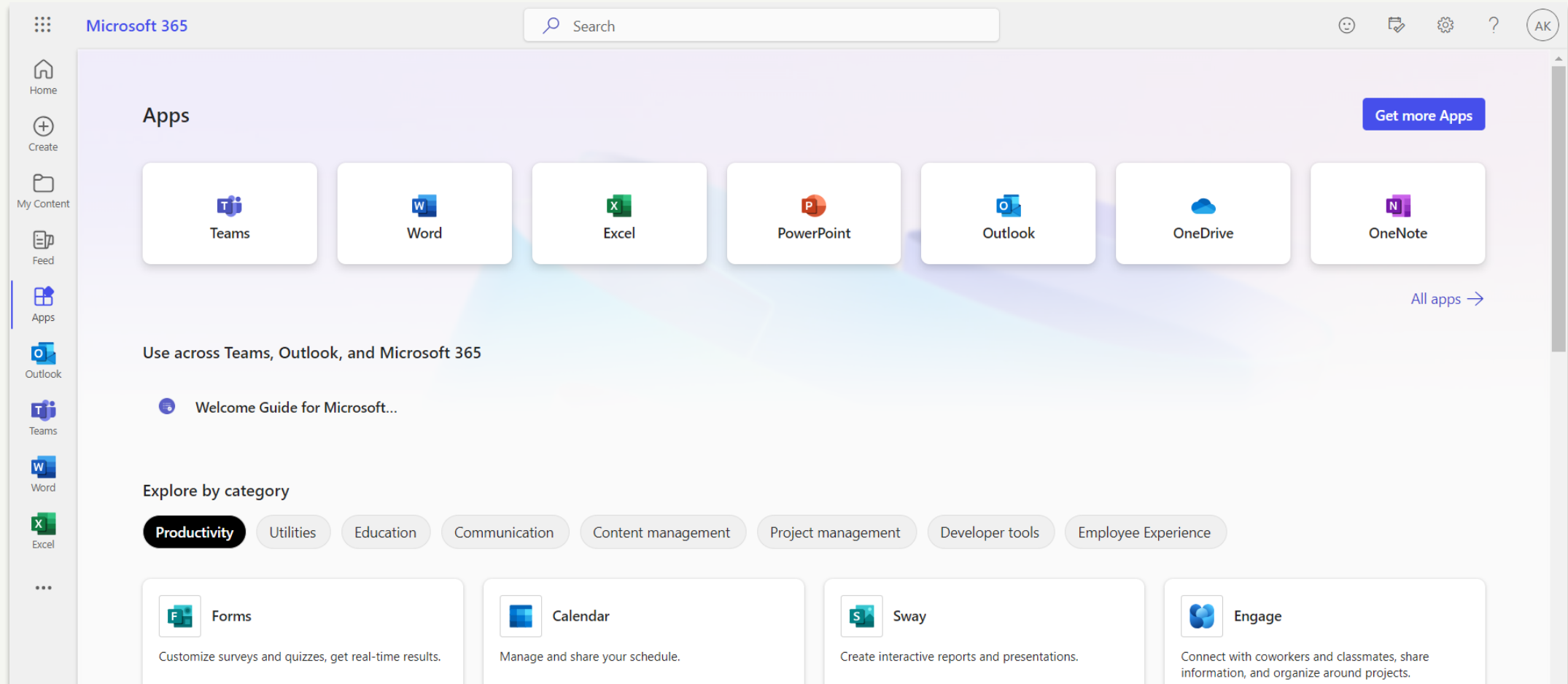
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STEP 1: MICROSOFT 365 SUBSCRIPTION

2

Obtain a Microsoft 365 Business Subscription

- Once subscribed, your Apps screen may look like this, depending on your plan.





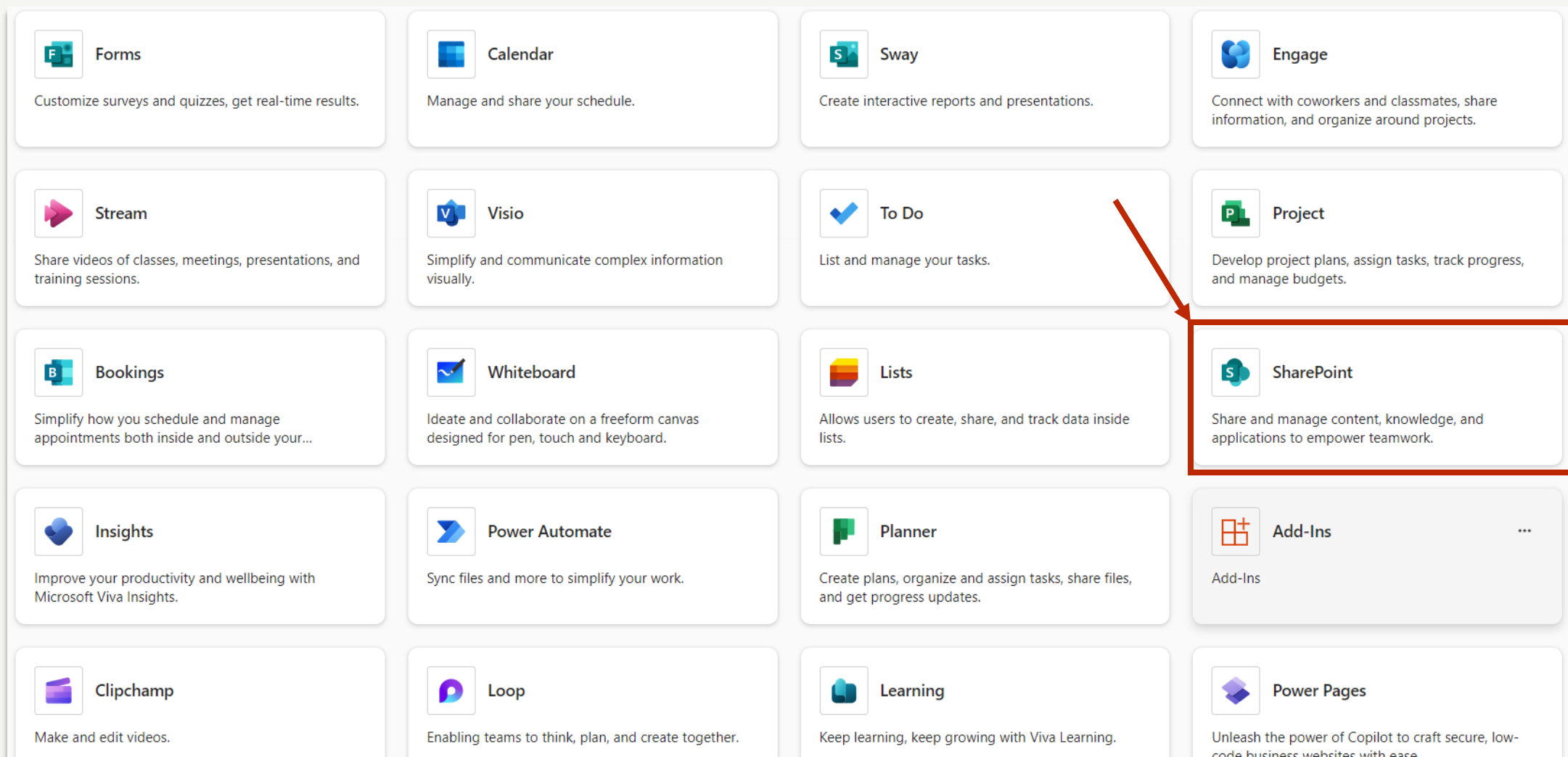
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STEP 2: ACCESSING SHAREPOINT

1

Click on SharePoint

- Log in to your Microsoft 365 account.
- In the Microsoft 365 App Launcher, click on the SharePoint icon.





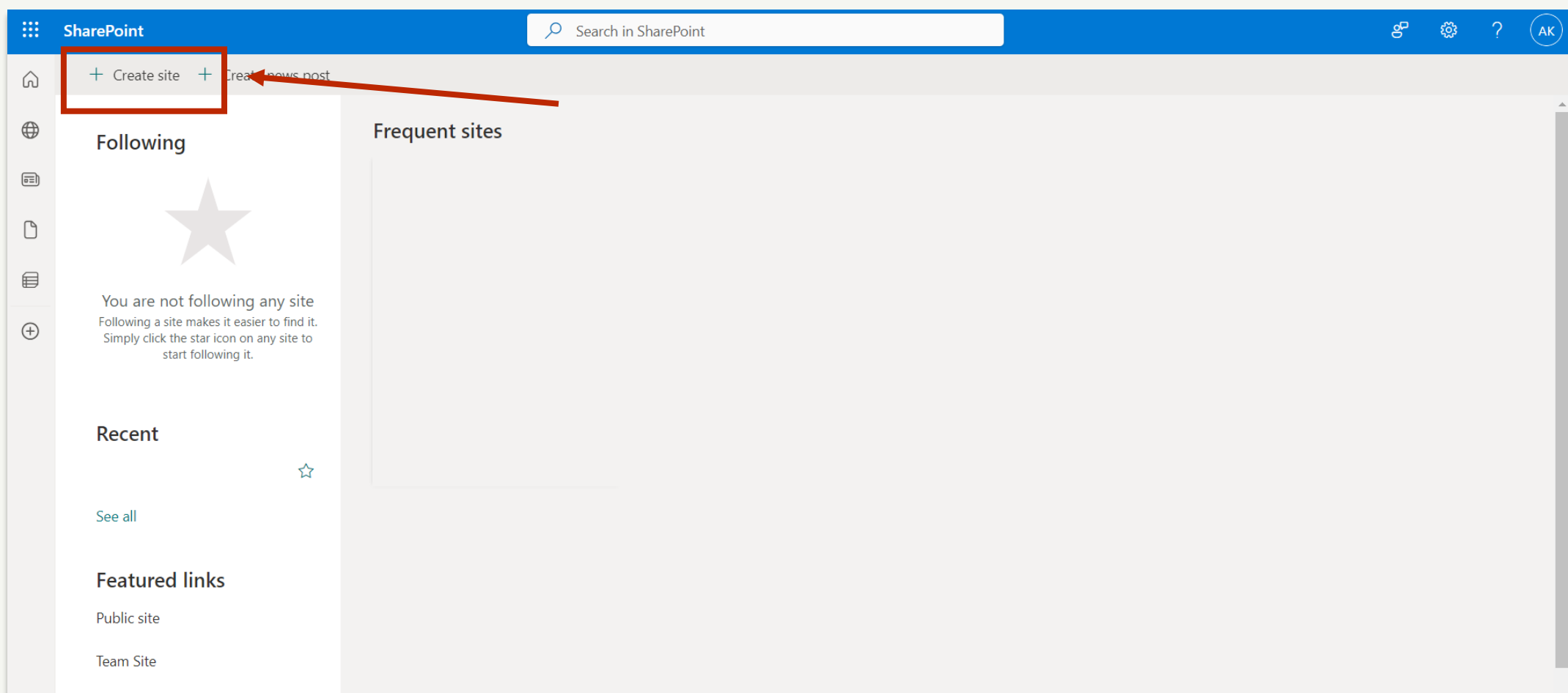
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STEP 3: CREATING A TEAM SITE

1

Create a Team Site

- Click on "Create site" on the SharePoint home page.





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STEP 3: CREATING A TEAM SITE

2

Create a Team Site

- Select "Team site"

Create a site: Select the site type

Select the type of site you want to create. [Learn more about team sites](#) or [learn more about communication sites](#).



Team site

Create a private space to collaborate with your team.

- 📅 Track and stay updated on project status
- 🔄 Share team resources and co-author content
- 👥 All site owners and members publish site content
- 🔗 Can connect to other Microsoft 365 products



Communication site

Share information that engages a broad audience.

- 📄 Create a portal or subject-focused site
- 👥 Engage dozens or thousands of viewers
- 👤 Few content authors and many site visitors



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STEP 3: CREATING A TEAM SITE

3

Create a Team Site

- You can select a template based on what you plan to create.
- We will use a “Standard Team” template

Select a template

From Microsoft From your organization

Standard team
Manage projects, share content, and stay cc your team.

Crisis communication team
Centralize crisis communication, resources, and best practices.

Employee onboarding team
Guide new employees through your team's onboarding process.

Event planning
Coordinate and plan event details with your team.

IT help desk
Welcome to the IT help desk. We help you solve your IT issues. For more information, visit the IT help desk.

Project Management
Project Management. Track your progress, manage your team, and stay on top of your work.

Recruitment team
Recruitment team. Manage your recruitment process, track your progress, and stay on top of your work.

Team Collaboration
Team Collaboration. Manage your team's collaboration, track your progress, and stay on top of your work.

You can change the site template later under Settings.

Back



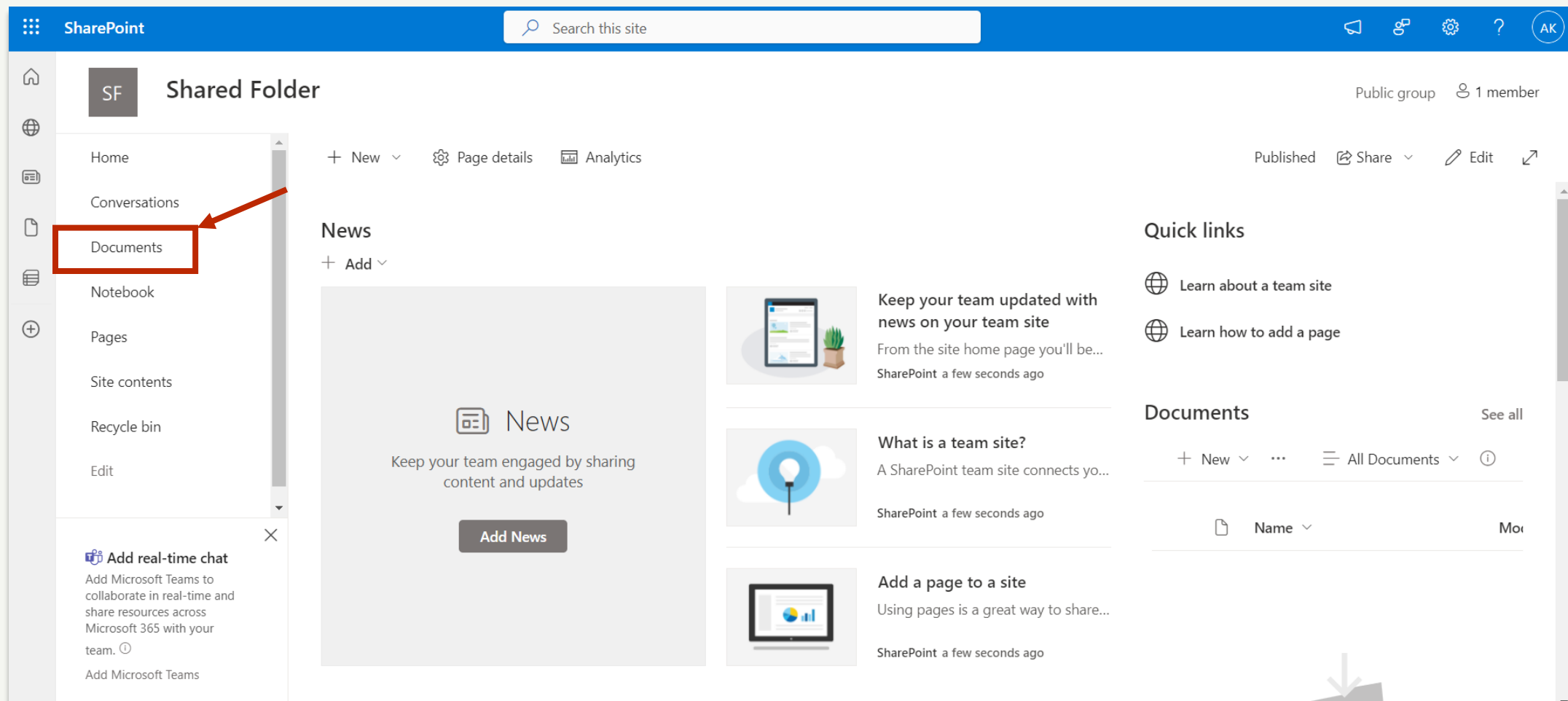
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STEP 3: CREATING A TEAM SITE

4

Create a Team Site

- Once you have provided initial information, you will have a page as illustrated in the image below.
- Click on 'Documents' to start creating folders.





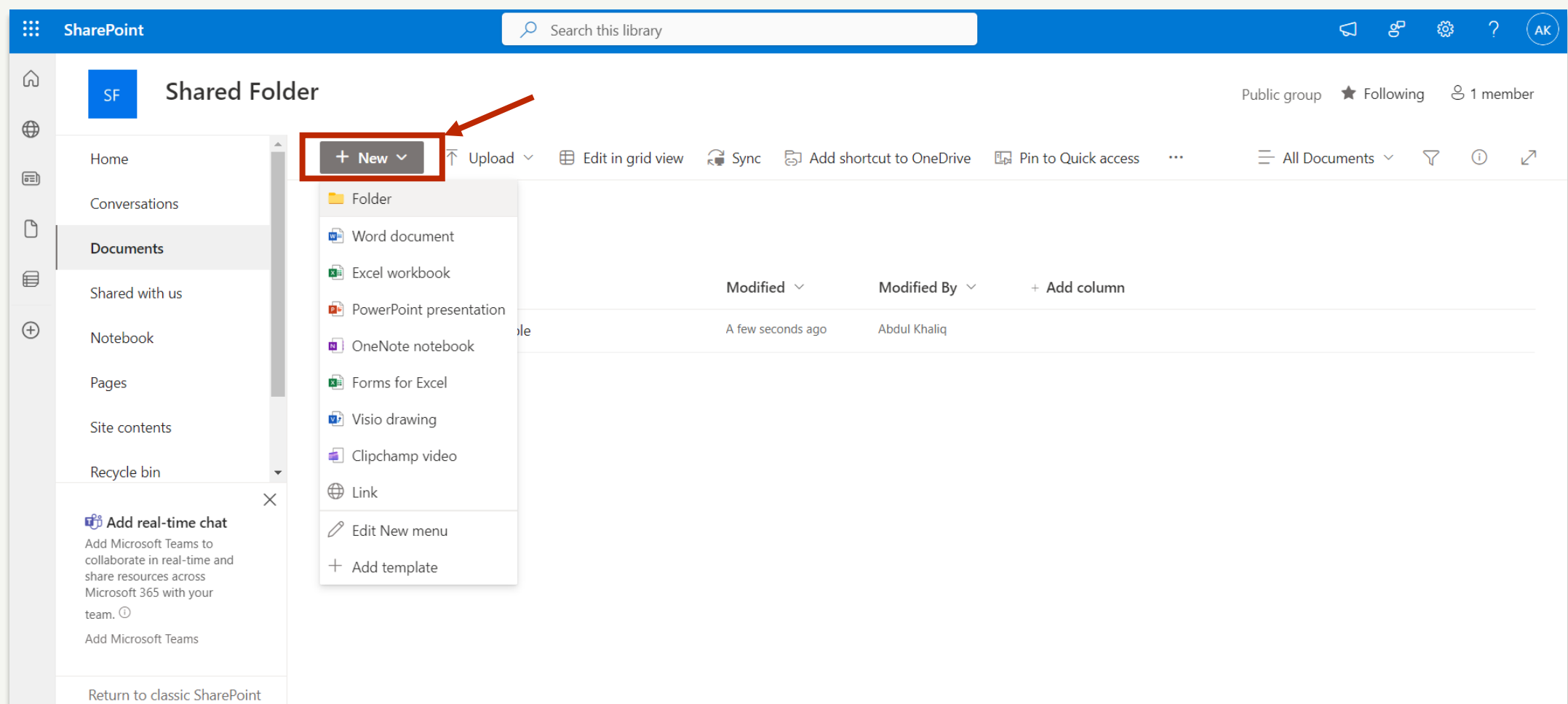
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STEP 4: CUSTOMIZE THE TEAM SITE

1

Customize the Site

- Navigate to your newly created team site.
- Customize the site by adding necessary libraries and lists.





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STEP 4: CUSTOMIZE THE TEAM SITE

2

Customize the Site

- Create a document library named "Invoices."
- Within the "Invoices" library, create two folders: "Pending" and "Approved."

The screenshot displays the SharePoint 'Shared Folder' interface. The left sidebar shows the navigation pane with 'Documents' selected. The main area shows the 'Invoices' document library. A table lists the contents of the library, with two folders highlighted: 'Approved' and 'Pending'. A red arrow points to the 'Name' column header, and a red box highlights the 'Approved' and 'Pending' folders.

Name	Modified	Modified By
Approved	A few seconds ago	Abdul Khaliq
Pending	A few seconds ago	Abdul Khaliq



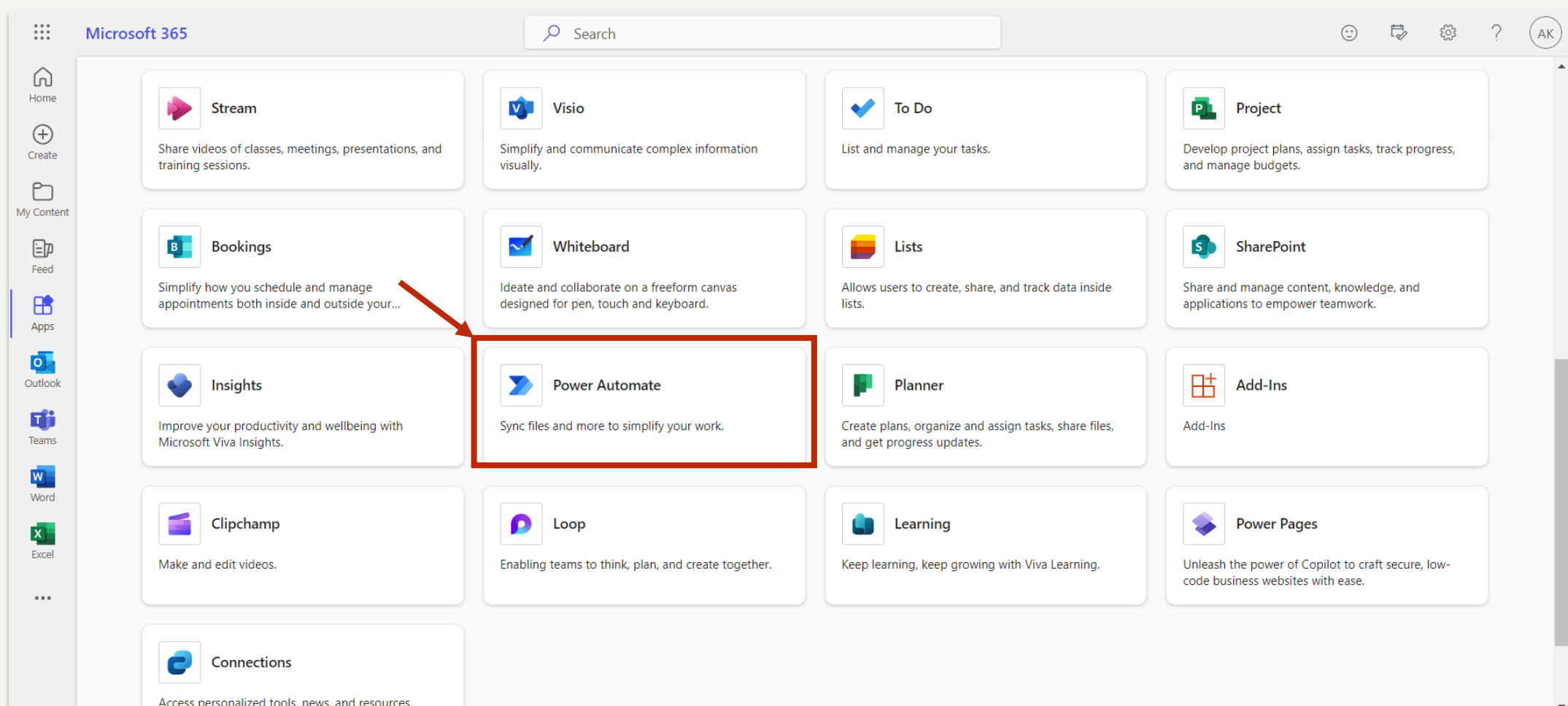
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STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

1

Go to Power Automate

- In the Microsoft 365 App Launcher, click on the Power Automate icon.



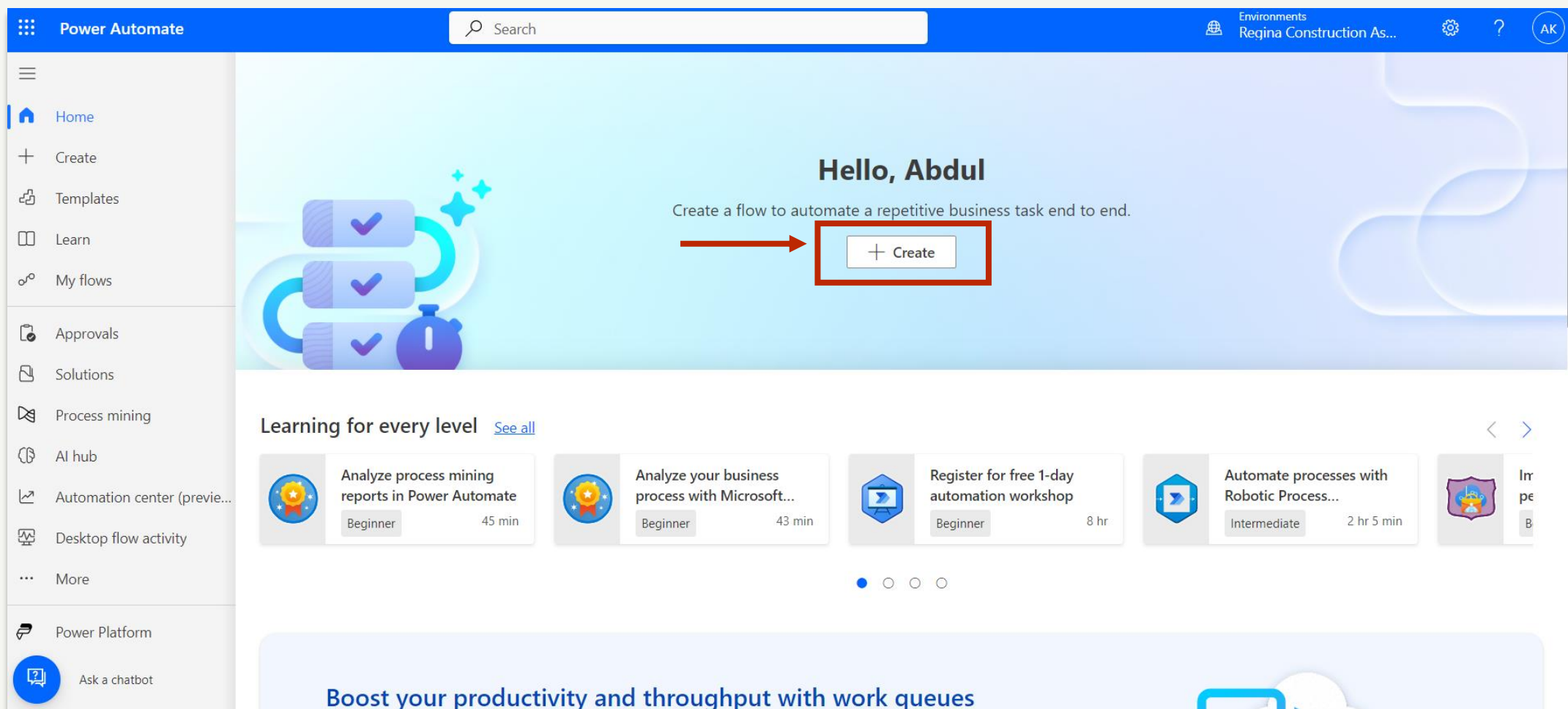


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STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

2 Create an Automated Flow

- A new screen will open as illustrated below.
- Click on "Create".





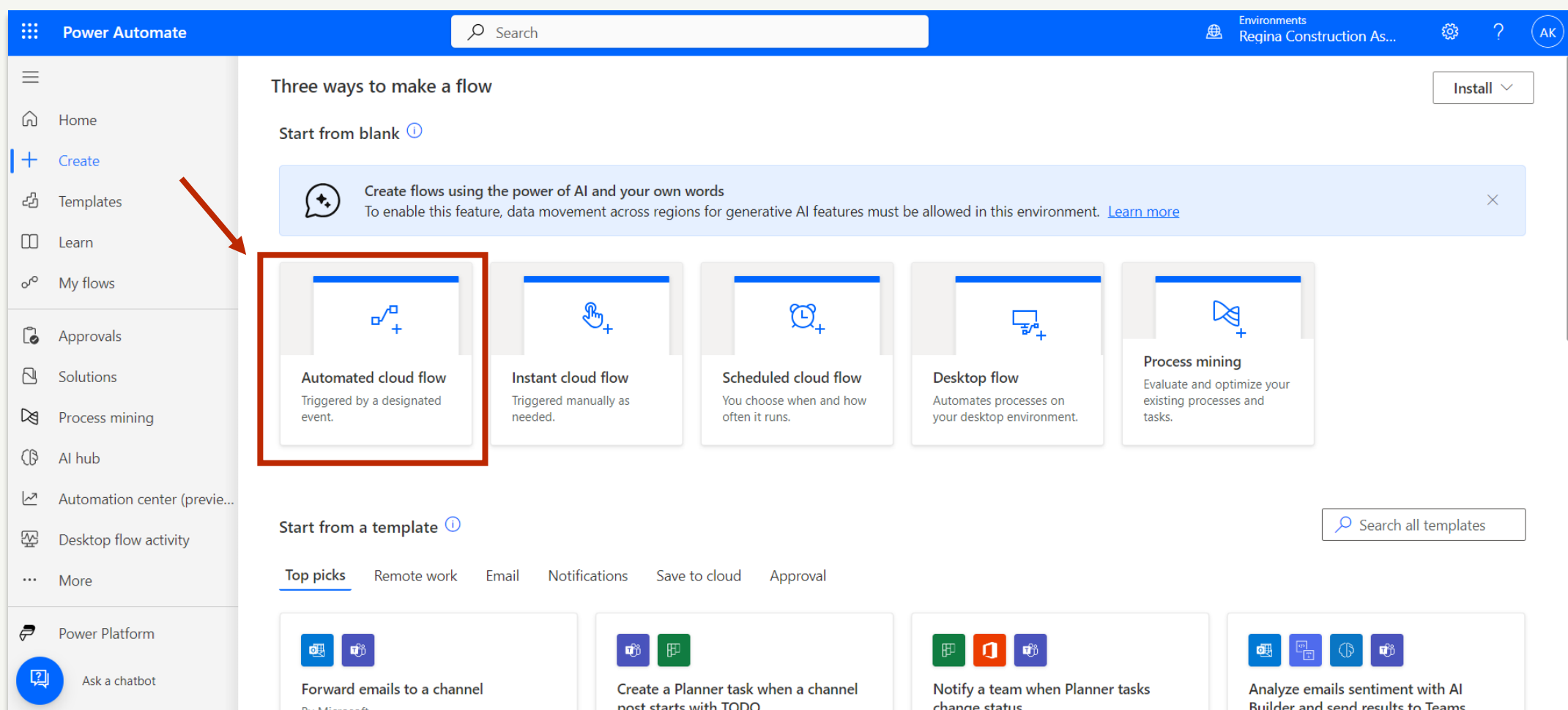
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STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

3

Create an Automated Flow

- A new screen will open as illustrated below.
- Click on "Create".





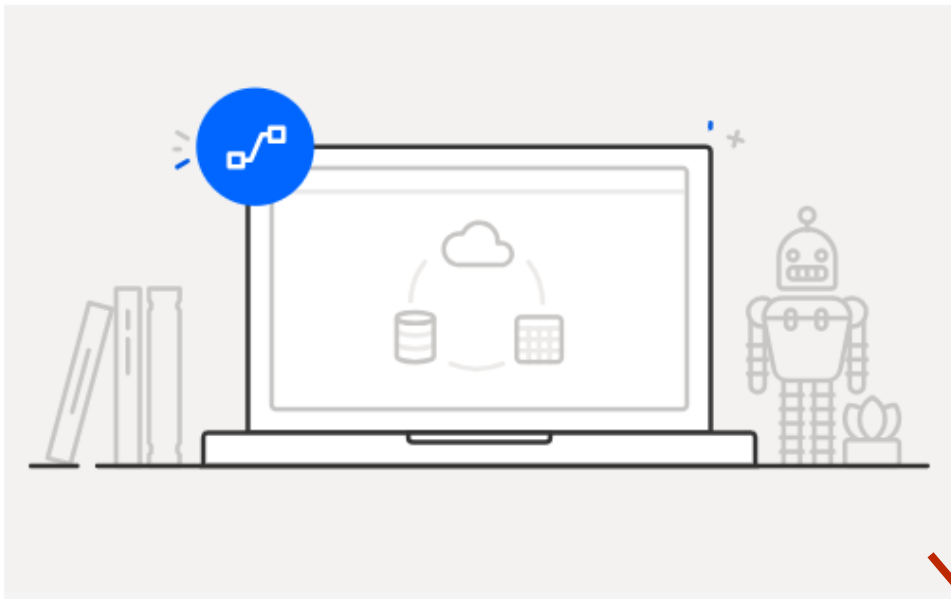
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STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

4 Create an Automated Flow

- In the "Build an automated flow" screen, search for "When a file is created or modified (properties only)" SharePoint trigger.

Build an automated cloud flow



Free yourself from repetitive work just by connecting the apps you already use—automate alerts, reports, and other tasks.

Examples:

- Automatically collect and store data in business solutions
- Generate reports via custom queries on your SQL database

Flow name

Invoice Approval Flow

Choose your flow's trigger *

Search or select a trigger from the list below to create a flow. (Required)

Search all triggers

When a new response is submitted
Microsoft Forms

When an item is created
SharePoint

✓ When an item is created or modified
SharePoint

When a file is created
OneDrive for Business

When a task is assigned to me
Planner



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STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

5 Create an Automated Flow

- Or ask AI to create the approval workflow for you automatically.
- You can also choose from suggested options.

Power Automate

Search

Environments
Regina Construction As...

Let's automate something. What should it do?

When a new file is created on Sharepoint, trigger an approval workflow

Generate

Suggested flow descriptions

- ⌚ Create an approval when a new file is created in sharepoint
- ⚡ If a new file is created in a sharepoint library, trigger an approval and email process
- ⚡ Create an approval when a new file is created in sharepoint
- ⚡ Start an approval process when a new file is created in sharepoint
- ⚡ When a new file is created in sharepoint, create a planner task and start an approval process
- ⚡ Start an approval process when a file is modified in a sharepoint library, and copy or update the file depending on the approval result

Learning for every level [See all](#)

Analyze process mining reports in Power Automate
Beginner 45 min

Automate processes with Robotic Process...
Intermediate 2 hr 5 min

Power Platform

Ask a chatbot



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STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

6

Create an Automated Flow

- AI will generate the suggested process.
- Click 'Next' to continue.

Power Automate

Search

Environments
Regina Construction As...

Describe it to design it

Step 1 of 2

What will your flow do?

Describe what you want to automate and AI will help you make it happen. [How it works](#)

Suggested flow

After you review this AI generated flow suggestion, select **Next** to configure it

Trigger
The flow starts when this happens

When a file is created in a folder (deprecated)
SharePoint

Actions
This is what the flow will do

Create an approval
Approvals

[This isn't what I'm looking for](#)

Next **Cancel**



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STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

7 Create an Automated Flow

- Click on each action and provide the information displayed in the box.
- Click 'Save' once done.

The screenshot displays the Microsoft Power Automate web interface. The top navigation bar includes the 'Power Automate' logo, a search bar, and user information for 'Regina Construction As...'. The main workspace shows a workflow titled 'When a new file is created on Sharepoint, trigger an approval workflow'. On the left, a panel for the 'When a file is created in a folder (deprecated)' trigger is open, showing parameters for 'Site Address' (https://reginaconstructiona.sharepoint.com/sites/SharedFolder) and 'Folder Id' (/Lists/Invoices). The main canvas shows the workflow steps: the trigger followed by a connector and then the 'Create an approval 1' action. Red arrows point to the 'Save' button in the top right, the trigger box, and the 'Create an approval 1' box.



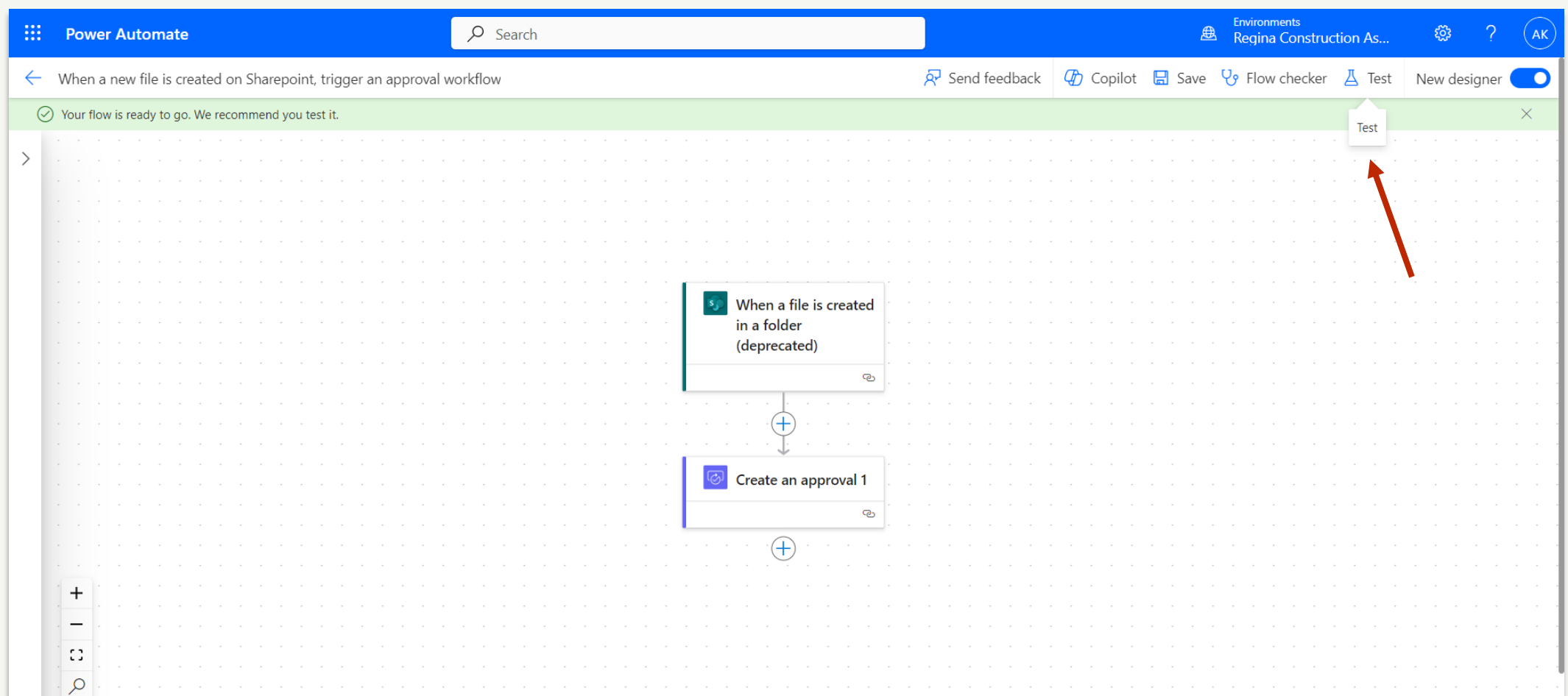
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STEP 5: SETTING UP POWER AUTOMATE

8

Create an Automated Flow

- Click 'Test' to test your flow.



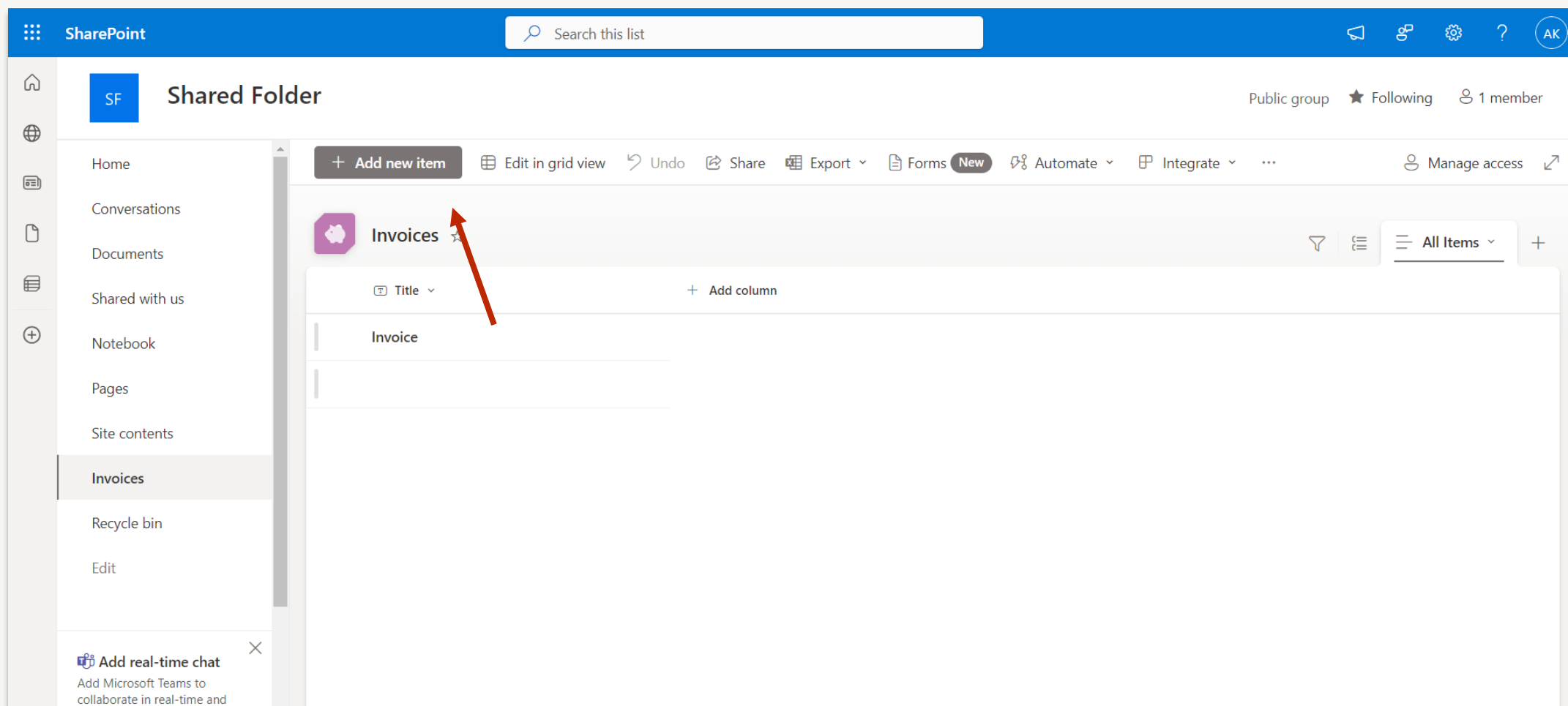


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STEP 6: TEST THE APPROVAL FLOW

1 Create an Automated Flow

- Test the flow by uploading a file to the folder in the SharePoint site and check if it triggers the approval process.



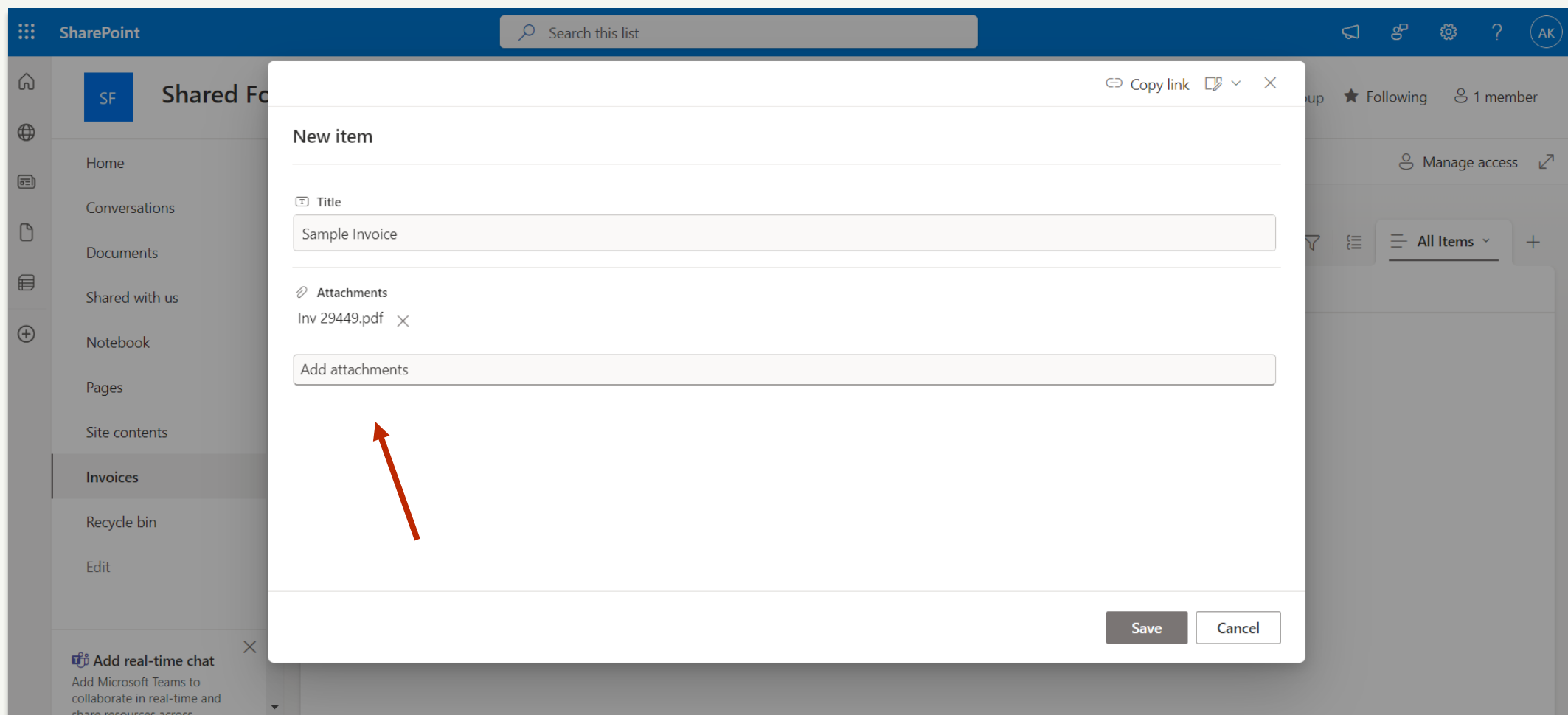


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STEP 6: TEST THE APPROVAL FLOW

2 Create an Automated Flow

- Go to 'SharePoint' and upload a file to test your workflow.
- Click 'Save' to trigger the approval flow.



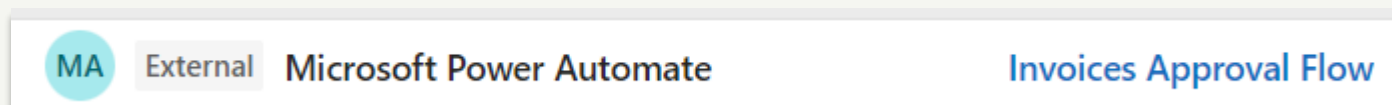


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STEP 6: TEST THE APPROVAL FLOW

3 Create an Automated Flow

- You will receive a notification on Teams and on your email that new item has been added for approval.
- You will also receive an email notification.



Approvals
Approval request details

Requested

Invoices Approval Flow

▼ Status: Requested

Pending response
Abdul Khaliq

Requested by
Abdul Khaliq

8/5/2024 11:38:10 PM

Comments

Add your comments here

More actions ▼

Reject

Approve



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CONGRATULATIONS

You just created an approval workflow!





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NEED HELP?
CONTACT ME TO HELP YOU
IMPLEMENT THE AUTOMATED
WORKFLOW FOR YOU!

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Fractional CFO/Controller | Helping SMEs
Drive Financial Success | Training and
Developing Future Finance Leaders



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